



MAS Behavior Management Policy 2025-2026

Behavior Management Policy

At Al Maaref American School (MAS), we recognize the importance of promoting acceptable behavior and methods of discipline within the school setting. We aim to provide a positive environment in which each student is respected and the right to learn is encouraged and protected. This guide provides specific aims and goals, teacher and staff responsibilities, strategies for acknowledgement and procedures for handling infractions of behavioral expectations.

Aims

We aim to ensure that positive behavior is rewarded; inappropriate behavior is dealt with firmly and fairly. The School Code of Conduct (see below) is framed in such a way as to encourage and reinforce courteous and civilized behavior – every opportunity is taken to support self-discipline, whereby children are personally involved and accept responsibility for their own actions and behavior.

We aim to move from a reactive disciplinary system that relies on punishment to a proactive approach that incorporates the principles of positive behavior support and self-regulation by students.

The system will increase our capacity to reduce school disruptions, and educate all students including those with problematic behaviors through the following:

- Clearly defined outcomes
- Supportive administrative systems
- Use of information for problem solving.

Our School's Code of Conduct – The Core Values

At this school we will:

- Have Respect, through your words and actions, be kind and respectful to everyone and to your surroundings, our time together matters; be present, prepared, aware, and engaged.
- Show Cooperation, be present, prepared, aware, and engaged.
- Take Responsibility, take ownership your actions – mistakes are opportunities for learning. Do the right thing when no one is watching, even when no one asks you.
- Give Tolerance, show patience for those who have different opinions or beliefs than yours. Be open-minded and celebrate each other's uniqueness and abilities.

The School's Code of Conduct will be posted in classrooms. Core Values Focus: Each rule will have a schoolwide focus for a set period during the year.

Roles and Responsibilities:

The designated people to handle behavior concerns for the school are the Teachers, and the Supervisors. If they are unavailable, then the following person should be contacted: Student Counselor

Practice and Procedure Guiding Principles:

Staff Responsibilities:

- Teachers and staff will teach, model and practice each of the behavioral expectations throughout the year.
- Teachers and staff will acknowledge student behaviors that meet the triple traits- Respect, Responsibility, and Ready to learn.
- Select and define expectations and routines. Expectations and routines need to be Observable, Acknowledgeable, and Teachable (OAT).
- Teach behaviors and routines directly in all settings.
- Actively monitor behavior.

- Acknowledge appropriate behavior.
- Teachers and staff complete the necessary documentation related to the behavior management policy and process.
- Any member of staff concerned about a student must inform the Supervisor immediately. He/ She will inform the counselor and the relevant people if needed, such as section principal.
- The members of staff must record information regarding their concerns on the same day. The record must be a clear, concise and factual account of the observations.
- To lead by example
- To be consistent in dealing with children
- To encourage the aims and values of the school among the children.
- To have high expectations of the children
- To meet the educational, social and behavioral needs of the children

Student Responsibilities

- Value the traditions and religious morals of the country and not offend the religion or the country.
- To support and care for each other
- To respect each other's property and work
- To listen to others and respect their opinions
- To take responsibility for their own actions and behavior
- To do as instructed by all members of staff (teaching and non-teaching)
- To observe the school's Core Values

Parents Responsibilities

- To be aware of our school's values and expectations
- To support the values and expectations of our school
- Make sure their child attends school regularly and punctually
- Make sure their child is dressed appropriately for school and has any necessary equipment

- Treat staff and other adults with courtesy and respect
- Discuss the school rules with their child. Talk to their child about their behavior.
- Listen to their child's point of view while also considering the other side
- Talk to their child's teacher or supervisor if they are concerned about a behavior issue.

Teaching and Learning

There is a designated person whose main tasks are to:

- Ensure that the Director of Administration/Marketing/Wellbeing/Section Principal is kept fully informed of any concerns.
- Ensure that all staff are aware of these procedures.
- Ensure that the safeguarding procedures are followed in the school.
- Ensure that appropriate training and support is provided to all staff.
- Undertake an investigation if a concern is raised.
- Decide whether to take further action regarding specific concerns.
- Ensure that accurate records are maintained and that these are kept in a secure place.

Positive strategies used to encourage good behavior:

The acknowledgement system is a feature of the behavioral expectation system. The behavioral expectation system focuses on acknowledging students who demonstrate behavioral expectations. Staff should follow these guidelines when acknowledging students:

- When staff observe students demonstrating expected behaviors, they acknowledge them by giving specific positive verbal feedback.
- Praise (verbal approval/acknowledgement such as that was a wonderful paragraph you wrote there (say students name) because...) *Note: use students name and give feedback separate + give praise separate.
- Written approval (e.g. writing 'super' on a completed worksheet).
- Non-verbal approval (e.g., smiling, nodding your head, clapping, a pat on the back, thumbs up).
- Social attention (e.g., a conversation, special time with the teacher or a peer).
- Social reinforcers – these are mediated by others (e.g. sharing success with family/peers, send student to colleagues/teachers/parents/principle to praise). They involve an

expression of approval and praise for appropriate behavior.

- Tangible reinforcers – for example, stickers, new pencils, washable tattoos, balloons, and awards such as certificates (displaying work in the classroom, or a letter sent home to parents praising students' progress can be used as reinforcement).
- Behavior charts celebrating good behavior (smiley face, stars, stickers).
- Activities or privileges such as playing a game, sitting in a special place in the class, drawing, writing, coloring, going to recess or gym early, having extra computer time.
- Activity reinforcers – involves allowing students to take part in their preferred activities if they behave appropriately. This is especially effective if they are allowed to choose a classmate with whom they can, for example, play a game or spend time on the computer with. This provides social reinforcement from their partner, too.
- Secondary positive reinforcements (such as checkmarks, tokens, positive box for monthly reward, certificates given in weekly assembly, golden time, house points, and STAR awards (safe, team player, active learner, respect) for students to accumulate in order to acquire tangibles or be allowed to participate in special activities.
- Token reinforcement – occurs when points or tokens are awarded for appropriate behavior. The rewards themselves have little value, but they can be collected, then exchanged for something valuable to the student. For example, every time a student shows a certain behavior, the teacher could give them a ticket. At the end of the week, tickets can be exchanged for a reward eg extra tablet time, job leader for the week etc no physical toys/gifts to be used.

Provide rewards for Assemblies e.g. certificates and in-class rewards e.g. Star of the Week

Handling Infractions of Behavioral Expectation

Al Maaref American School will maintain a level system for handling infractions of behavioral expectations. Outlined below is the level system along with the instructions for handling such behaviors:

Level 1 Behaviors include:

- Not bringing the necessary books and/or equipment to class
- Tardiness
- Unexplained absences
- Defiance, disrespect, insubordination, non-compliance
- Breaking school rules in the classroom, hallways, playground and school buses
- Disruptive behavior in the classroom, school or school buses (Please see disruptive follow- up steps)
- Incorrect school uniform

Step 1: Level 1 behaviors are to be handled by the specialist teacher or staff member witnessing such behaviors and written in the **Record book** for the given class.

If learning is disrupted, the students' name should be recorded on the board for the first warning, followed by a tick next to the name for the second. After which the Record book should be updated and the teacher contacted to remove and to talk with student and message home from teacher explain behavior and consequences.

Step 2: The teacher should monitor the *Record Book* and after a student has their name recorded in the *Record Book* three times, The specialist teacher schedules a longer meeting with the student for the purposes of goal setting. The teacher and student will complete the **Goal Setting Sheet**. Teacher will then share it with his/her parent.

Step 3: If level 1 behaviors have not improved after **Goal Setting Sheet**, the supervisor will have meeting with the student and then contacts the parents and discuss the next steps i.e. parent meeting, counseling, **weekly behavior monitoring plan**. The counselling referral form to be completed before counseling session with the school counselor.

Step 4: After step 1-3 will result in a leveled 1 behavior warning letter. Meeting between supervisor, parent and the student.

Level 2 Behaviors include:

- Inappropriate or abusive language
- Defying school authority and staff
- Mocking others/unkindness
- Trespassing
- Pushing/Shoving
- Technology violations/cyber bullying/ Using cellphones during school time

- Bringing mobile phone to school or misusing any means of communication
- Consistent rude attitude towards adults or supporting staff
- Theft
- Vandalism
- Leaving school/classroom without permission
- Bringing mobile phone to school or misusing any means of communication
- Cheating on exams or assignments
- Fighting with other students/Bullying
- Providing false documents (e.g. signing letters without the knowledge of parents)

Level 2 behaviors will be handled by the teacher witnessing such behaviors and will be recorded in the record book directly, and a Break Reflection during break parent will be informed, parent meeting with Supervisor to discuss the next steps (parent meeting, counseling, **weekly behavior monitoring plan** after having reflection with the Teacher/supervisor.

For level two offenses that involve vandalism, parents may be held responsible for paying all or part of the cost of rectifying any defacing damage, or destruction of school property caused by their child or children's act of vandalism.

****If no improvement, after the above (2 or more Level 2 offenses) the student is issued a Level 2 Warning Letter and is suspended from attending school and behavior is documented in his/her record. Students are suspended from attending school until behavior improves or until the end of discipline period.**

Level 3 Behaviors include:

- Fighting with teachers, staff members and/or community members
- Use, possession of weapons or that could be used as one
- Assault and sharing/distributing pornographic material
- Willful damage or destruction of the school/personal property
- Using/possession of illegal and inappropriate substances
- Harassment, teasing, taunting (physical and/or verbal)
- Abusive Language/Racist remarks
- Exchanging inappropriate materials and photos, etc.
- Bullying/Racism

Level 3 behaviors should be referred to the Counselor immediately with documentation of the offense from Specialist Teacher or Section Supervisor. Thereafter, a **Counselor Referral Form** should be completed and documentation of those who witnessed the incident and student statement form to be attached. The parents are contacted, and student is sent home for the day, a formal meeting with Counselor /Section Principal is held with the parents and student, an agreed code of conduct is signed by parents and student. A **First Level 3 Warning** will be issued that requires parent signature and this is kept on the child's file.

At the discretion of the principal, students will be suspended from attending school or be placed on in-school suspension for up to 3-5 days.

Repeated Level 3 offenses will result in parent and Section Principal/ School Principal intervention meetings alongside receiving a Level 3 Warning Letter suspension from school. If this happens, the local authorities are contacted.

Behavior Management Strategies

Low level behavior management strategies:

- The look!
- Oral warning
- Repositioning of children
- Proximity
- Counting down from 5
- Refocusing/diversions
- Simple and clear directions
- Rule reminders
- Avoidance of the word "No"
- Private discussion with child
- Non-verbal signs
- Reminder of code of conduct – the golden rules
- Giving a choice
- Giving a warning of a consequence
- In-class "time out"
- Out of class "time out"

- Stay in at break time (in a supervised area)
- Loss of privileges/choice of activity (e.g. reduced Golden Time)
- Counselor conducts regular sessions to support positive behavior

Encouraging respect for others:

- Circle work – developing “language of feelings”
 - Role plays restorative conversations and deals with difficult scenarios
 - Sharing skills
 - Training children in conflict resolution skills
 - Giving children responsibility e.g. School Council, Class Representative, Playground Pals
 - Praising children and letting them know they are all valued
 - Staff modelling the message in their interaction with each other and with other members of the school community
 - MAS runs bullying prevention activities to create awareness, and ensure prompt and appropriate intervention when incidents occur.
 - Bullying in any form is not tolerated, as it undermines the principles of respect, tolerance, and acceptance that are fundamental to our school community.
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